Personalities & Appointments

> **Priority B** Match List questions love new presidents, governors, Speakers, CDS, and regulators.

What to note every time

Ask yourself	Why
Exact name?	Spelling matters
Exact post?	Office and country
When appointed or elected?	Date
Is the person of Indian origin?	High alert for

Landmark National Appointments Foundation (Late 2025)

Office / Commission	Appointee	High-Yield Prelims Detail
8th Central Pay Commission	**Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai**	Appointed **Chairperson** (October 2025); former Supreme Court Judge and Delimitation Commission head.
53rd Chief Justice of India	**Justice Surya Kant**	Assumed office on **24 November 2025** as India's 53rd CJI.
Central Industrial Security Force (CISF)	**Praveer Ranjan**	Appointed **Director General (DG)**.
26th Chief Election Commissioner of India	**Gyanesh Kumar**	Elected **Chair of the Council of Member States of International IDEA** for 2026 in Stockholm, Sweden.
India's BRICS Sherpa	**Sudhakar Dalela**	Led the 1st BRICS Sherpas and Sous-Sherpas meeting under India's 2026 Chairship.

Preeti Saran — CESCR re-election | 2026

What happened Former Indian diplomat **Preeti Saran** was **re-elected** to the UN **Committee on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (CESCR)**.

Core facts

- Body: **CESCR** (ICESCR monitoring committee), not ECOSOC membership itself.
- She has also served as **Chair** of CESCR.
- Name traps in options: **Ruchira Kamboj**, **Eenam Gambhir**, **Sneha Dubey**.

> **Trap**

CESCR ≠ ECOSOC. For the 2026 CESCR re-election stem, the name is **Preeti Saran**.

NYC proclaims Dr B. R. Ambedkar Day | 14 April 2025

What happened New York City Mayor **Eric Adams** proclaimed **14 April 2025** as **Dr B. R. Ambedkar Day** in New York City. The proclamation was announced at a UN Headquarters commemorative event.

Core facts

- Date linked to Ambedkar's birth anniversary (**14 April**).
- Mayor name in stems: **Eric Adams** (not Bill de Blasio; not London's Sadiq Khan).
- Announced by NYC Mayor's Office for International Affairs (Deputy Commissioner Dilip Chauhan) in the presence of MoS **Ramdas Athawale**.

> **Trap**

Swap mayor names. The 2025 NYC proclamation belongs to **Eric Adams**.

Global Leadership Transitions & Key International Appointments (2025–2026)

Office / Country	Leader	Month / Year	High-Yield Prelims Detail
Japan (Prime Minister)	**Sanae Takaichi**	October 2025	Designated **104th Prime Minister of Japan**; **first woman to ever serve as Prime Minister of Japan** (and President of LDP).
Nepal (Prime Minister)	**Balendra Shah ("Balen")**	March 2026	Structural engineer, rapper, and former Mayor of Kathmandu; led Rastriya Swatantra Party (RSP) to victory following the 2025 youth "Gen Z Movement"; became **Nepal's youngest Prime Minister**.
Nepal (Interim Prime Minister)	**Sushila Karki**	Late 2025	Former Chief Justice of Nepal; served as interim Prime Minister, becoming the **first female Prime Minister in Nepal's history**.
UN General Assembly (81st Session)	**Khalilur Rahman**	September 2026	Foreign Minister of **Bangladesh**; elected **President of the 81st UNGA Session** (theme: *"Restoring Trust, Managing Transformation"*).
Albania (Public Procurement)	**Diella**	September 2025	**World's first AI-powered Minister** (*Diella* = "sun" in Albanian); integrated into the *e-Albania* digital portal to supervise tenders and curb corruption.
France (Prime Minister)	**Sebastien Lecornu**	September 2025	Appointed Prime Minister of France by President Emmanuel Macron following the resignation of François Bayrou.
Poland (President)	**Karol Nawrocki**	August 2025	Assumed office as President of Poland, succeeding Andrzej Duda after defeating Rafal Trzaskowski.
Australia (Prime Minister)	**Anthony Albanese**	May 2025	Sworn in for a **second term** as Prime Minister of Australia on 13 May 2025.
Guyana (President)	**Irfaan Ali**	September 2025	Re-elected for a second term as President of Guyana (first Muslim head of state in 2020).
Cameroon (President)	**Paul Biya**	October 2025	Re-elected for his **8th consecutive term** at age **92**; remains the **world's oldest serving head of state**.

January 2026

Leaders in the India–EU meeting

These were visiting leaders, not new Indian appointments, but names are still asked.

- **António Costa** — President of the European Council.
- **Ursula von der Leyen** — President of the European Commission.
- They met Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** in New Delhi on **27 January 2026**.

Award winners from January are listed under Awards.

Sergio Gor | U.S. Ambassador to India | credentials 14 January 2026

What happened Sergio Gor presented credentials to President **Droupadi Murmu** at Rashtrapati Bhavan on **14 January 2026** and formally became the **27th** United States Ambassador to India.

Core facts

- Arrival / took charge at the U.S. Embassy, New Delhi: **12 January 2026**.
- Credentials ceremony: **14 January 2026**.
- Succeeds the earlier vacancy after **Eric Garcetti**.
- Country for stems: **United States of America** (not Italy / France / Germany).

> **Trap**

Date trap: charge **12 Jan** vs credentials **14 Jan**. Country trap: USA only.

Regulatory & Statutory Appointments

- **Atomic Energy Regulatory Board (AERB): A. K. Balasubrahmanian** assumed office as Chairperson (1 January 2026).

National Obituaries

- **Prof. Madhav Gadgil (Passed away 7 Jan 2026 at age 83):** Eminent ecologist and environmental champion; headed the milestone **Western Ghats Ecology Expert Panel (WGEEP / Gadgil Commission)**.

February 2026

Names linked with February news

- Finance Minister **Nirmala Sitharaman** presented her **ninth** Union Budget.
- **Arvind Panagariya** is Chairperson of the **16th Finance Commission**.
- **Rouble Nagi** won the Global Teacher Prize 2026.

If a clear PIB appointment of a Governor, CDS, Election Commissioner, or regulator appears later, add a full card here with name, post, and date.

March 2026

Vikram Doraiswami | Ambassador to China

What happened Around mid-March, coverage said **Vikram K. Doraiswami** was appointed India's Ambassador to **China**. He earlier served as High Commissioner to the United Kingdom.

National Commission for Backward Classes (NCBC)

- **Sadhvi Niranjan Jyoti** assumed charge as the **Chairperson** of the National Commission for Backward Classes (NCBC) in March 2026.

Other names in March news

- Defence Minister **Rajnath Singh** chaired the DAC meeting that cleared about **₹2.38 lakh crore** of proposals.
- Cricket captain **Suryakumar Yadav** led India to the T20 World Cup title in coverage of the final.

April 2026

Key appointments in April coverage

- **Harivansh Narayan Singh** — Deputy Chairman, Rajya Sabha (keep exact election/date from an official note if a stem needs it).
- **Ashok Lahiri** — Vice Chairperson, NITI Aayog.
- **Lt Gen Dhiraj Seth** — Vice Chief of the Indian Army.
- **Ashwini Bhide** — first woman Commissioner of the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (**BMC**).

Soft international names

- **Roman Gofman** — Chief of Mossad (Israel).
- **Susan Coyle** — first female Army Chief of Australia.

Defence and diplomacy names already in April news

- Defence Minister **Rajnath Singh** commissioned INS Taragiri / Aridhaman events at Visakhapatnam.
- ROK PM **Lee Jae-myung** visited India for the bilateral summit.

May 2026

Top defence and service appointments

- **General N. S. Raja Subramani** took charge as **Chief of Defence Staff (CDS)**, succeeding **General Anil Chauhan** (around end-May).
- **Vice Admiral Krishna Swaminathan** — Chief of the Naval Staff.
- **Saurabh Vijay** — CEO, **UIDAI**.
- **Prasoon Joshi** — Chairman, **Prasar Bharati**.

Soft political / House names

- **Raghav Chadha** — Chairman, Rajya Sabha Committee on Petitions.

Soft firsts already covered elsewhere

- Squadron Leader **Saanya** — first woman Cat-A flying instructor in the IAF.
- CJI **Surya Kant** linked with the Sikkim paperless judiciary announcement.

June 2026

Key appointments in June coverage

- **FATF Vice-President:** India elected for the first time; **Vivek Aggarwal** appointed as Vice-President of the Financial Action Task Force for the term July 2026 – June 2027.
- **Lokhande Prashant Sitaram** — Chairperson, **CBSE**.
- **Saurabh Vijay** — CEO, **IndiaAI Mission** (also earlier linked with UIDAI in May coverage; fact the post named in the stem).
- **Neelkanth Mishra** — India's Executive Director at the **World Bank**.
- **Dr Saibal Chattopadhyay** — Chairperson, **National Statistical Commission**.
- **Tushar Mehta** — Solicitor General term extended (about three years in coverage).

June Obituaries

- **Dr. Subhash C. Kashyap (Passed away 4 June 2026 at age 97):** Renowned constitutional jurist, scholar, and former **Secretary-General of the Lok Sabha** (author of authoritative treatises on Indian Parliamentary procedure and the Constitution).

Soft tech name

- **Kunal Shah** named as WhatsApp CEO in June compilations (global tech appointment; soft fact only).

July 2026

Key appointments in July coverage

- **Pralhad Joshi** — Union Education Minister.
- **Anurag Jain** — CEO, **NITI Aayog**.
- **Viswanathan Anand** — Interim President of **FIDE** (world chess body).

Soft diplomacy names

- PM Modi received Indonesia's **Bintang Adipurna**.
- UK PM change: **Andy Burnham** succeeds Keir Starmer in late-July coverage.

August 2026

Key appointments in August coverage

- **Hari Ranjan Rao** — Director General, **Sports Authority of India (SAI)**.
- **Vice Admiral A. N. Pramod** — Vice Chief of the Naval Staff.

Soft foreign names

- **Mirza Fakhrul Islam Alamgir** — President of Bangladesh (coverage).
- **Abelardo de la Espriella** — President of Colombia (coverage).

September 2026

National Commission for Safai Karamcharis (NCSK)

What happened The Social Justice Ministry announced fresh leadership of the **National Commission for Safai Karamcharis**.

What you should remember

- Chairperson: **Bhagwat Prasad Makwana**.
- Vice-Chairperson: **Kaishab Bihari**.
- Members named in the PIB note: **Manoj Kumar Balmiki**, **Sushma Gaudiyal**, **Ravi Ramu Kalose**.
- Tenure in the note: up to **31 March 2028** (remaining tenure of the present Commission).

UNGA 81st Session President

- **Khalilur Rahman** (Bangladesh) — President of the **81st UNGA** session from **8 September 2026**.
- Full card → International.

Soft ACC / other September appointments

- CBSE Chairperson (ACC coverage): **Mandeep K. Bhandari**.
- DWBDNC Governing Body members: **Narayan Dewasi** and **Swaroop Singh Banjara**.

October 2026

51st Chief Justice of India | Justice Sanjiv Khanna

What happened On **24 October 2026**, the President of India officially notified the appointment of **Justice Sanjiv Khanna** as the **51st Chief Justice of India (CJI)**, with effect from **11 November 2026**.

Core biographical & constitutional facts - **Succeeds: Chief Justice D.Y. Chandrachud**, who retires on **10 November 2026** after serving as the 50th CJI for two years. - **Tenure:** Justice Khanna serves as CJI until his retirement on **13 May 2025** (a tenure of approximately 6 months upon reaching the constitutional retirement age of **65 years** under **Article 124(2)**). - **Subsequent Succession:** Justice **B.R. Gavai** is slated to succeed him as the 52nd CJI in May 2025. - **Heritage:** Nephew of the illustrious Supreme Court judge **Justice H.R. Khanna**, famed for his sole, historic dissenting judgment in the *ADM Jabalpur v. Shivkant Shukla (Habeas Corpus)* case during the 1976 Emergency. - **Key Benches:** Authored landmark judgments on the sanctity of EVM-VVPAT verification, electoral bonds declaration, and right to information (RTI) applicability to the office of the CJI.

> **UPPCS Constitutional Trap**

Do not confuse the retirement age of Supreme Court Judges (**65 years** under Article 124) with High Court Judges (**62 years** under Article 217). The oath of office of the CJI is administered by the **President of India** under the Third Schedule.

Key Executive & State Appointments | October 2026

Position / Office	Person Appointed	Date & Context	Significance
51st Chief Justice of India	**Justice Sanjiv Khanna**	Appointed **24 Oct 2026** (Oath 11 Nov)	Succeeds CJI D.Y. Chandrachud; 6-month tenure till May 2025.
Chief Minister of Haryana	**Nayab Singh Saini**	Sworn in **17 Oct 2026** (Panchkula)	Second term; administered by Governor Bandaru Dattatreya.
Chief Minister of UT of J&K	**Omar Abdullah**	Sworn in **16 Oct 2026** (Srinagar)	**First Chief Minister of the Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir**.
Deputy Chief Minister of J&K	**Surinder Kumar Choudhary**	Sworn in **16 Oct 2026**	MLA from Nowshera, representing the Jammu region.
54th Dadasaheb Phalke Award	**Mithun Chakraborty**	Conferred **October 2026**	India's highest cinematic honor presented by President Droupadi Murmu.

Practice Zone — UPPCS Format

> **20 questions** for this sheet only — drill after you revise the months above. Formats match UPPCS 2024–25: multi-statement, Match List, NOT-matched, A/R, chronology. Full cross-topic index → Practice Zone hub.

Q1. Who among the following succeeded General Anil Chauhan as the Chief of Defence Staff (end-May 2026 coverage)?

A. General Manoj Pande B. General N. S. Raja Subramani C. General Upendra Dwivedi D. Admiral Dinesh K. Tripathi

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: CDS succession — Subramani after Chauhan. **Ans: B.** General **N. S. Raja Subramani** is the CDS fact. Trap: inserting a recent Army Chief name as CDS.

Q2. Which of the following statements is/are correct for April–May 2026 national coverage?

1. Kankaria depot (Ahmedabad) was covered as the first water-neutral railway depot.
2. Harivansh Narayan Singh was covered as Rajya Sabha Deputy Chairman.
3. Ashok Lahiri was covered as Vice Chairperson of NITI Aayog.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Kankaria water-neutral depot; Harivansh / Ashok Lahiri. **Ans: D.** Firsts + appointments. Trap: swapping NITI Vice Chair with CEO (Anurag Jain appears later).

Q3. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists.

List-I (Post)	List-II (Name in 2026 coverage)
A. CDS	1. Ashok Lahiri
B. NITI Aayog Vice Chairperson	2. General N. S. Raja Subramani
C. Union Education Minister	3. Pralhad Joshi
D. NITI Aayog CEO	4. Anurag Jain

Row order is not the answer code.

A. 2 1 3 4 B. 2 1 4 3 C. 1 2 3 4 D. 2 3 1 4

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Match List — post ↔ name (UPPCS favourite). **Ans: A.** CDS→Subramani; NITI Vice Chair→Lahiri; Education→Joshi; NITI CEO→Jain. Trap: swapping Vice Chair and CEO.

Q4. With reference to May–August 2026 service appointments, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Vice Admiral Krishna Swaminathan was covered as Chief of the Naval Staff.
2. Vice Admiral A. N. Pramod was covered as Vice Chief of the Naval Staff.
3. General Anil Chauhan continued as CDS through August 2026.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Naval / service chiefs. **Ans: A.** (3) false — Subramani succeeded Chauhan around end-May. Trap: stale CDS name.

Q5. Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

1. Harivansh Narayan Singh — Rajya Sabha Deputy Chairman
2. Saurabh Vijay — CEO, UIDAI (May coverage)
3. Lokhande Prashant Sitaram — Chairperson, CBSE
4. Neelkanth Mishra — India's Executive Director at the World Bank

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1, 2 and 3 only B. 2, 3 and 4 only C. 1, 3 and 4 only D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: April–June civilian appointments cluster. **Ans: D.** All four appear in personalities coverage. Trap: putting CBSE chair under UGC.

Q6. With reference to diplomacy names in 2026 coverage, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. António Costa is President of the European Council; Ursula von der Leyen is President of the European Commission.
2. Vikram K. Doraiswami was covered as India's Ambassador to China.
3. António Costa is President of the European Commission.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: EU leaders + Ambassador Doraiswami. **Ans: A.** (3) swaps the two EU presidents. Classic personality Match trap.

Q7. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Prasoon Joshi was covered as Chairman of Prasar Bharati.
2. Viswanathan Anand was covered as Interim President of FIDE.
3. Hari Ranjan Rao was covered as Director General of SAI.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Soft regulators / House names. **Ans: D.** Media / chess / sports admin cluster. Trap: writing Anand as permanent elected FIDE president without "Interim".

Q8. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Nirmala Sitharaman presented her ninth Union Budget in 2026 coverage.
2. Arvind Panagariya chairs 16th Finance Commission.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Sitharaman ninth Budget. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q9. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Vikram K. Doraiswami covered as Ambassador to China.
2. He earlier served as High Commissioner to the UK.
3. He was appointed CDS.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Doraiswami China ambassador. **Ans: A.** (3) false.

Q10. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Suryakumar Yadav led India in Men's T20 WC final coverage.
2. Rajnath Singh chaired the March DAC meeting.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Suryakumar T20 captain. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q11. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Ashwini Bhide — first woman BMC Commissioner.
2. Lt Gen Dhiraj Seth — Vice Chief of Army in April coverage.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Ashwini Bhide BMC first woman. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q12. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Saurabh Vijay linked with UIDAI CEO in May coverage.
2. Also linked with IndiaAI Mission CEO in June coverage — fact the post named in the stem.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: UIDAI / IndiaAI Saurabh Vijay care. **Ans: C.** Both true — stem-specific.

Q13. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Tushar Mehta Solicitor General term extended (~3 years) in coverage.
2. Dr Saibal Chattopadhyay — Chairperson, National Statistical Commission.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Tushar Mehta SG extension. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q14. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. UK PM change: Andy Burnham succeeds Keir Starmer in late-July coverage.
2. Viswanathan Anand — Interim FIDE President.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Andy Burnham UK PM soft July. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q15. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Mirza Fakhrul Islam Alamgir covered as President of Bangladesh.
2. Hari Ranjan Rao — DG, SAI.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Bangladesh President soft Aug. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q16. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Roman Gofman — Chief of Mossad (Israel) in soft international names.
2. Susan Coyle — first female Army Chief of Australia.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Roman Gofman Mossad soft. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q17. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. ROK leader Lee Jae-myung visited India for April summit coverage.
2. Summit stressed semiconductors, shipbuilding, batteries.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Lee Jae-myung Korea visit. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q18. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Raghav Chadha — Chairman, Rajya Sabha Committee on Petitions.
2. Prasoon Joshi — Chairman, Prasar Bharati.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Raghav Chadha RS petitions. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q19. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Kunal Shah named as WhatsApp CEO in June compilations (soft global tech fact).
2. He was appointed RBI Governor in the same note.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Kunal Shah WhatsApp soft. **Ans: D.** (2) false.

Q20. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Neelkanth Mishra — India's ED at the World Bank.
2. Lokhande Prashant Sitaram — CBSE Chairperson.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Neelkanth Mishra World Bank ED. **Ans: C.** Both true.